Sample IT Procedure: Checking Windows Service Status

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1. Purpose

This procedure describes read-only methods for viewing the status and basic details of Windows services on a server or workstation.

2. Scope

Use this procedure when checking whether a Windows service is running or stopped, or when collecting service details for an investigation. This document covers inspection only. It does not provide instructions for starting, stopping, restarting, disabling, or changing services.

3. Check service status using the Services console

1. Open the Windows **Start** menu.

2. Search for **Services** and open the Services application. If permitted, the console can also be opened by running **services.msc**.

3. Locate the service by its name or display name.

4. Review the **Status** column. A service may show **Running** or may have no running status displayed.

5. Select the service to review its displayed name, description, and startup type. Do not change any properties as part of this procedure.

4. Check service status using PowerShell

Open PowerShell and run the following read-only command to list service names, display names, and statuses:

```
Get-Service | Select-Object Name, DisplayName, Status
```

To check one service by its service name, replace **Spooler** with the required service name:

```
Get-Service -Name "Spooler"
```

These commands display service information. They do not start, stop, or modify services.

5. What to record

- Server or computer name.
- Service name and display name.
- Service status shown at the time of checking.
- Date and time of the observation.
- Relevant alert or incident reference, if applicable.

6. Important precautions

- This procedure is for viewing service information only.
- Do not start, stop, restart, disable, or change a service using this procedure.
- A stopped service is not automatically a fault; confirm the expected service state using the applicable approved procedure.
- Follow your organization's access, approval, and change-management processes before making any service changes.

End of sample procedure. This document is fictional and intended only for testing the OpsPilot learning project.